Ze Fu

Curriculum Vitae

Institut Jean Nicod, École Normale Supérieure – PSL
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Current Position

2025–present **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Institut Jean Nicod, ENS–PSL, Paris
Affiliated with Sciences Po since November 2026
Advisor · Nicolas Baumard

Education

2019–2025 **Ph.D., Psychology (Cognitive Neuroscience)**, Beijing Normal University, China
Advisor · Yanchao Bi

2016–2017 **Visiting Student, Psychology**, University of California, Berkeley

2014–2019 **B.S., Psychology (Computer Science minor)**, Central China Normal University

Publications and Manuscripts

First / Co-first Author

2026 **Fu, Z.**, Chu, Y., Zhang, T., Li, Y., Wang, X., Bi, Y. Semantic similarity across languages reflects neurocognitive dimensions shaped by climate. *Nature Communications*, 17, 4016.

2025 **Fu, Z.***, Chen, H.*, Liu, Z., Sun, M., Liu, Z., Bi, Y. Pathogen stress heightens sensorimotor dimensions in the human collective semantic space. *Communications Psychology*, 3, 2.

2023 **Fu, Z.**, Wang, X., Wang, X., Yang, H., Wang, J., Wei, T., Liao, X., Liu, Z., Chen, H., Bi, Y. Different computational relations in language are captured by distinct brain systems. *Cerebral Cortex*, 33, 997–1013.

Contributing Author

2024 Tian, S.*, Chen, L.*, Wang, X., Li, G., **Fu, Z.**, Ji, Y., Lu, J., Wang, X., Shan, S., Bi, Y. Vision matters for shape representation: Evidence from sculpturing and drawing in the blind. *Cortex*, 174, 241–255.

2023 Tian, S., Chen, Y., **Fu, Z.**, Wang, X., Bi, Y. Simple shape feature computation across modalities: Convergence and divergence between the ventral and dorsal visual streams. *Cerebral Cortex*, 33, 9280–9290.

Manuscripts under review

Fu, Z., Zhong, Y., Baumard, N. Recursive representations of minds increased independently across literary traditions.

Talks & Conference Presentations

2026 **Text mining reveals a cross-linguistic shared semantic space associated with climate**, Invited online lecture at Computational Neurolinguistics Forum (hosted by CUHK), Hong Kong
Oral

2025 **Semantics across the globe**, International Workshop on Cross-linguistic Databases and Norms, Shanghai
Poster

2024 **Representing historical cognition in language models**, AI for Psychology Journal Club, Tsinghua University
Oral

2024 **Application of language models to semantic cognition**, Lab Meeting, Zhejiang University
Oral

2024 **Semantics across the globe**, Rovereto Workshop on Concepts, Actions, and Objects, Trento, Italy
Poster

2023 **Ecological drivers of cross-cultural semantic structures**, Conceptual Brains and Cultural Evolution Workshop, Zhuhai
Oral

2023 **Pathogen stress heightens sensorimotor dimensions**, Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Marseille
Poster

2021 **Graph and vector-embedding models**, Society for the Neurobiology of Language, Online
Slam

Mentorship

2023–2024 **Undergraduate Thesis Supervision**, Supervised 3 theses (including Outstanding Thesis Award recipient).

2022–2024 **Research Training Programs**, Mentor for undergraduate research in the Innovation & Entrepreneurship Training Program.

Professional Service

Reviewer *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, *Imaging Neuroscience*, *Cognitive Neuropsychology*, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, *npj Science of Learning*, and *Discover Artificial Intelligence*.

Co-review *Nature Human Behaviour*.

Funding and Awards

2025–2026 Fyssen Foundation Postdoctoral Study Grant

2023 Award for Research and Innovation, Beijing Normal University

2020–2023 Graduate Academic Award, Beijing Normal University

Technical Skills

Programming Python; R; MATLAB

Statistics Multilevel modeling; Network analysis; Time-series modeling; Large-scale corpus analysis

Methods fMRI; Cross-linguistic modeling; LLM-based semantic analysis; Online behavioral experiments

Languages Chinese (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)